

ANIME

Tomodachi Game

★★★★☆ | Tomodachi Game is an anime which essentially follows the same pattern as Squid Game but with a twist. In Squid Game, the people competing for the prize money were total strangers. But, Tomodachi Game is a bit different. The word "Tomodachi" literally translates to "Friend" in English. Hence, in the anime, people still get together and compete for a prize money but the twist is that the people who are competing against each other are best friends.

The anime revolves around the story of 5 high school best friends. All of them seem meek and joyful at first but get progressively evil as the episodes progress. Two of them were in charge of collecting two million yen for the class trip. The full amount of the fund is collected but on



the day of submission, the funds mysteriously vanish. The people in charge are held responsible and on the same night, all of the five friends get kidnapped and get taken to play the Tomodachi Game.

That was the basic plot of the anime. You must be thinking that this

is the same thing as Squid Game but with different packaging. But that's where you're wrong. You see, the "best friends as your competitors" factor plays a very important role here. Even beyond that, the main character of the anime Katagiri Yuuichi is a COMPLETE PSYCHOPATH. You may not realise it in the first few episodes but if you're a fan of psychological anime then you'll definitely appreciate the MC's IQ and approach to problems. Although there is a lot to talk about this anime, there is just one thing that we're concerned with. The character development. The show spent literally no time on character development and getting the viewer attached with the characters of the show. We kid you not, in the first 10 minutes of the first episode itself, all the drama that we mentioned above takes place, and the first game has already started. Aside from that, the anime is really good with some great twists and turns which are guaranteed to keep you at the edge of your seat.

—Kshipra Jadav

TV SERIES

Love Death + Robots

★★★★☆ | Season 3 of Love Death & Robots finally comes close to matching both the cinematic brilliance and quality of stories that Season 1 unleashed on our unsuspecting eyes -- yes, apart from a couple of episodes, we don't like to mention the disappointment that was Season 2. The collection of short, bite-sized journeys through sci-fi, horror, and comedy thoroughly outdid itself.

In fact, LDR S3 has some of the most breathtaking combination of stories, art style and performances you can experience anywhere right now, not just on Netflix. Seriously, it's that good. It begins with an episode full of dystopian comedy that feels all too real, where humanity has crumbled and robots



are having the last laugh. The giggles continue into an old farmer's over-industrialised war on agricultural pests that don't know how to lose. Two textbook sci-fi stories regurgitate the classic premise of astronauts on alien planets with interesting twists and turns, and of course, spell-binding visuals that make

you pause the action and marvel at each scene's artistic brilliance. The stories aren't too shabby either, they draw you in and hold your attention till the last minute -- whether it's a stranded voice on a Jovian moon or scientists stretching the limits of human curiosity.

Two more stories delve into Earth-bound terrors unleashed upon unsuspecting soldiers in a manner that can be only described as beautifully grotesque. And two stories in this season of LDR simply blow you away! Never has a ship of sailors delivered so much suspense and drama in so little time as the characters of Bad Travelling -- a phenomenal short episode that deserves a full movie. It's the same high standard delivered by Jibaro, where a knight in shining armour is seduced by a siren in the woods -- it's so intense, with so much going on, that you don't even realize there's no dialogue. Both these episodes remind us why we all fell in love with LDR, why it's so very good!

—Jayesh Shinde